



Computers save us from epidemics

Scientists are able to use computers and predict whether animals might harbour dangerous epidemic-causing microorganisms. <http://digit.in/1IQP4vs>

Beer for ladies only

A gender-detecting beer billboard in Hamburg lit up only when ladies pass by it: <http://digit.in/1Hv7W1k>

Multiple component organ failure? Stuck while overclocking a GPU? And more..

If you're someone who's having trouble getting a hold of what synthetic memory benchmark results mean when it comes to real world memory performance, or you're just frustrated after witnessing the death of precious PC components one after another, fret not! Team Digit is here to save the day for you.

Q Is it alive?

I was a regular desktop user from a long time but that changed when I bought a laptop around more than a year ago. I started using the laptop extensively because I was never at the same place for more than a few weeks and hence my desktop was left neglected all this while.

Recently when I powered on my desktop after close to 15-16 months, I noticed that it was running super slow. This was unusual because the last time I used it, it was working absolutely fine. In order to rectify this, I opened the desktop, disconnected and reconnected most of the cables, re-seated the RAM and graphics card. I also replaced the HDD that the PC had with an SSD but to no avail. The system still ran extremely slow. Reinstalling Windows was an ordeal in itself as it took me more than a day to get it done

because of the slow speed. I even updated most of the drivers which took a similarly long time.

The PC also failed to install motherboard drivers as the setups couldn't run for some unknown reason and kept auto-closing. I can't seem to wrap my head around what's wrong with the PC.

Any pointers on what I should do would be really appreciated.

—Omkar Shete

A Frequently changing addresses and moving with a desktop while also not using it for a long time have always been known to cause their own set of troubles as we see in your case.

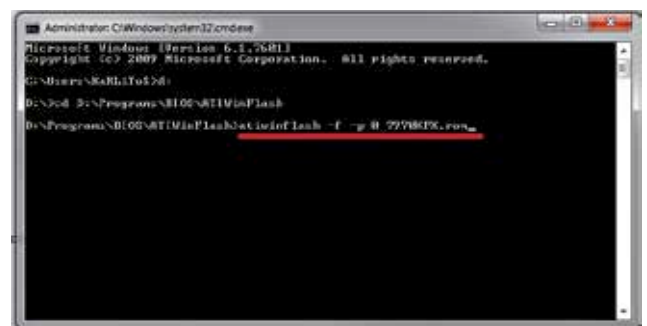
Since you've already tried disconnecting and reconnecting stuff inside, we would suggest you to compartmentalise your approach towards figuring out what's wrong. Start by going from one component to another component like checking out whether the PC will POST with only one stick of RAM installed along with the CPU on the board but without anything else like storage drives or other drives.

If everything goes smoothly, install the graphics card next and check again. Do this in a step-wise manner for each component as you finish testing one and move on to the other like the HDD next, for example. This process will most likely help you find out the component(s) that is(are) at fault.

It would also help if you can somehow test each of your components individually on another PC as this would let you perfectly identify faulty hardware and set it aside. If all the components are working as they should be, the desktop's motherboard is most likely the one with issues. Get a hold of another compatible motherboard for your components and try running the desktop with it. If it works, buy a new board and you'll be set.

Q GPU OC After effects

Okay so, I had an old ATI Radeon HD5450 (XFX One/1GB DDR3) which previously



Use the correct flags to ensure a proper recovery

belonged to my brother. I wanted get some extra performance out of it but couldn't set the memory clock any higher than 600 MHz due to locked voltage controls, which is frustrating because usually 5450s are clocked at 800 MHz by default.

So, after struggling a lot with Afterburner and Trixx, I decided to flash its BIOS because in that form it was of no use to me. The flashing process was successful. I used a BIOS clocked at 800 MHz. But after I rebooted the PC, the display went all crazy with random letters,

